ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

GRADE 7

ENGLISH FIRST ADDITIONAL LANGUAGE

PAPER 1 · LANGUAGE IN CONTEXT

MARKS: 70 **TIME: 2 hours**

Section A: Comprehension (25) · Section B: Summary (10) · Section C: Language in context – advertisement, cartoon and language structures (35). All texts were written by Academic Central.

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the CAPS curriculum for Grade 7. It is not a Department of Basic Education examination paper.

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. This question paper consists of THREE sections: SECTION A: Comprehension (25 marks), SECTION B: Summary (10 marks) and SECTION C: Language in context (35 marks).
2. Answer ALL the questions.
3. Read ALL the texts carefully before you answer the questions.
4. Number your answers exactly as the questions are numbered.
5. Answer in full sentences unless you are told otherwise.
6. Spend about 50 minutes on Section A, 20 minutes on Section B and 50 minutes on Section C.

SECTION A: COMPREHENSION

QUESTION 1

Read the text below and answer the questions that follow.

Lerato's Garden

1 When Lerato Mokoena started Grade 7 at Thuto Primary School in Soweto, the first thing she noticed was the empty space behind the school hall. It was full of broken desks, old tyres and weeds that grew as tall as she was. Most learners walked past it without a second look. Lerato, however, saw something different. She saw a garden.

2 Her grandmother had grown spinach, tomatoes and onions in their tiny backyard for as long as Lerato could remember. "Soil is like a bank," Gogo always said. "If you put something good in, you get something good back." Lerato decided to test that idea at school.

3 She wrote a letter to the principal, Mr Dube, asking for permission to clean up the space. At first he was doubtful. "Who will look after it during the holidays?" he asked. "And where will the water come from?" Lerato had expected these questions. She showed him a plan: the Eco Club would take turns to water the garden, and rainwater from the hall roof would be collected in two old drums.

4 Mr Dube was impressed, but he gave her one condition. "If the garden is still growing in six months," he said, "the school will pay for a proper water tank."

5 The first weeks were hard. Only four learners came to the first Eco Club meeting, and two of them left when they saw how much work had to be done. Lerato and her friend Sipho spent three Saturdays dragging the broken desks to the gate so that the municipality could collect them. They filled the old tyres with soil and compost and planted seedlings that a local nursery had donated.

6 Then something unexpected happened. Learners who had laughed at them began to stop and ask questions. A boy from Grade 5 brought seeds from home. The Grade 6 class painted the tyres in bright colours. By the end of the second term, the Eco Club had thirty-two members and a waiting list.

7 In September the garden produced its first big harvest: twenty bunches of spinach and two crates of tomatoes. The vegetables were used in the school's feeding scheme, and some were sold to parents to buy more seeds.

8 Six months after their meeting, Mr Dube kept his promise. A 5 000-litre water tank now stands next to the hall. When a journalist from a community newspaper asked Lerato how she had done it, she smiled. "I didn't do it," she said. "We did. I just planted the first seed."

1.1	Describe the space behind the school hall before Lerato started the garden. Give TWO details.	(2)
1.2	"Lerato, however, saw something different." (paragraph 1) What did Lerato see, and what does this tell us about her?	(2)
1.3	Explain in your own words what Gogo meant when she said, "Soil is like a bank."	(2)
1.4	Mr Dube asked two questions in paragraph 3. Write down each problem he raised and explain how Lerato planned to solve it.	(4)
1.5	What condition did Mr Dube give Lerato?	(2)
1.6	Quote ONE word from paragraph 3 which shows that Mr Dube was not sure about the idea at first.	(1)
1.7	Why do you think two learners left after the first Eco Club meeting?	(1)
1.8	Give ONE word from paragraph 5 that means "given as a gift".	(1)
1.9	Paragraph 6 begins: "Then something unexpected happened." Explain what was unexpected.	(2)
1.10	Mention TWO ways in which the vegetables from the first harvest were used.	(2)
1.11	Is the following statement TRUE or FALSE? Give a reason for your answer. *Lerato paid for the water tank herself.*	(2)
1.12	What does Lerato's answer to the journalist show about her character? Give a reason.	(2)
1.13	Do you think a garden like this would be a good idea at your school? Give a reason for your answer.	(2)

[25]

SECTION B: SUMMARY

QUESTION 2

Read the text below. List SEVEN tips for saving water at home.

1. Write SEVEN points in full sentences, numbered 1 to 7.
2. Use your OWN words as far as possible.
3. Your summary must not be more than 70 words. Write the number of words you used at the end.

Every Drop Counts

South Africa is a dry country, and every family can help to save water. Start in the bathroom, where most water is used. A shower of five minutes uses much less water than a full bath, so choose a short shower whenever you can. While you brush your teeth, turn off the tap; an open tap can waste about six litres of water every minute. Check your home for dripping taps and leaking toilets, and ask an adult to fix them quickly, because a small drip can waste thousands of litres in a year. In the kitchen, wash dishes in a basin instead of under running water. Keep a jug of drinking water in the fridge so that you do not have to let the tap run until the water is cold. Outside, water the garden early in the morning or late in the afternoon, when less water evaporates. Finally, collect rainwater in a tank or bucket and use it for plants and for washing the car.

[10]

SECTION C: LANGUAGE IN CONTEXT

QUESTION 3: ADVERTISEMENT

Study the advertisement below and answer the questions.

SMILE BRIGHTER WITH SPARKLE!

Now with **double fluoride** for stronger teeth

9 out of 10 kids say Sparkle tastes better than ordinary toothpaste.*
Fights cavities all day long. Choose **Fresh Mint** or **Bubble-gum** flavour!

BUY 2, GET 1 FREE – this month only at all leading stores!

Sparkle – because every smile matters.

*Survey of 50 children in Gauteng, 2026.

Sparkle is a made-up product, used only for this examination.

3.1 What product is being advertised? (1)

3.2 Who is the target audience of this advertisement? Give a reason from the advertisement for your answer. (2)

3.3 Quote TWO words or phrases that are used to persuade people to buy the product. (2)

3.4 What is the purpose of the asterisk (*) after the word "toothpaste"? (1)

3.5 Read the small print at the bottom. Do you think the claim "9 out of 10 kids" is convincing? Explain your answer. (2)

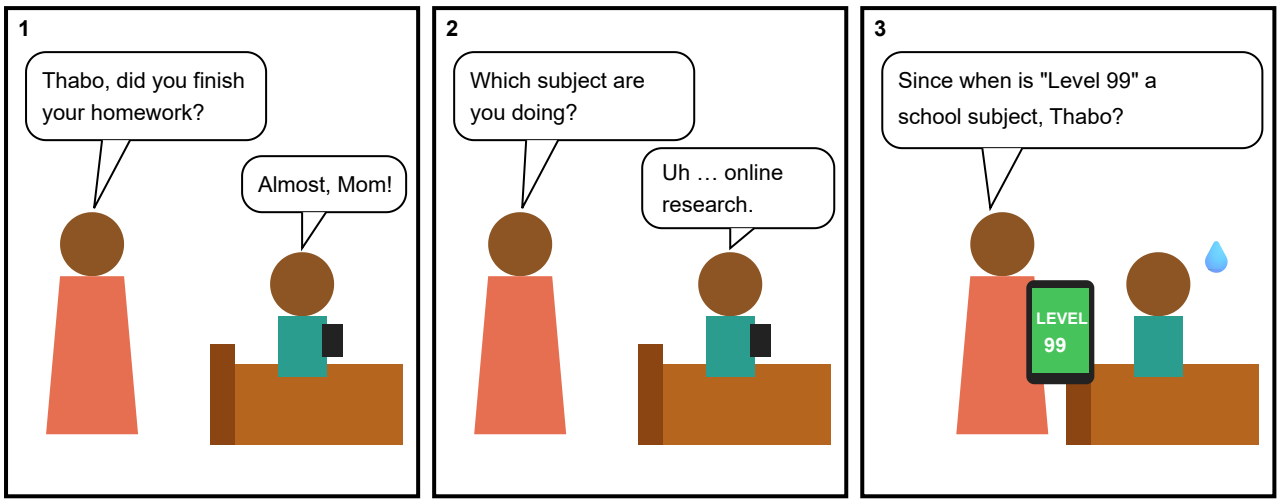
3.6 Why does the advertiser use the words "this month only"? (1)

3.7 Write down the slogan of the advertisement. (1)

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QUESTION 4: CARTOON

Study the cartoon below and answer the questions.



4.1 Look at frame 1. Where is Thabo sitting, and what is he holding? (2)

4.2 Is Thabo telling the truth in frame 1? Explain your answer by referring to frame 3. (2)

4.3 Why does Thabo say "Uh …" in frame 2? (1)

4.4 Choose the word that best describes Mom's tone in frame 3: proud / sarcastic / frightened / joyful (1)

4.5 Rewrite Mom's words in frame 1 in indirect (reported) speech. Begin with: *Mom asked Thabo …* (2)

[8]

QUESTION 5: LANGUAGE STRUCTURES AND CONVENTIONS

Read the paragraph below and answer the questions. The sentences are labelled (a) to (g).

> (a) Last Saturday our class visit the Johannesburg Zoo. (b) The bus left the school at eight o'clock. (c) We saw lions, elephants and a family of meerkats. (d) The guide told us that a herd of elephants can drink hundreds of litres of water in one day. (e) My friend Zinhle was more excited than anyone else. (f) "This is the best trip ever!" she shouted. (g) We will definitely go back next year.

5.1 There is a verb error in sentence (a). Write down the correct form of the verb. (1)

5.2 Rewrite sentence (b) in the simple future tense. (1)

5.3 Write down the plural of: (a) family (b) bus (2)

5.4 Write down the collective noun in sentence (d). (1)

5.5 (a) Give the superlative form of "excited" in sentence (e). (b) Give the positive (basic) form of "best" in sentence (f). (2)

5.6 Rewrite sentence (f) in indirect speech. Begin with: *Zinhle shouted that …* (2)

5.7 Write down the adverb in sentence (g). (1)

5.8 Write down ONE proper noun from sentence (a). (1)

5.9 Join these two sentences with a suitable conjunction: *We were tired. We were very happy.* (1)

5.10 Give the antonym (opposite) of "left" in sentence (b). (1)

5.11 Rewrite the sentence with the correct punctuation and capital letters: *can we feed the animals asked thabo* (3)

5.12 Add a prefix to the word "possible" to give it the opposite meaning. (1)

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TOTAL SECTION C: [35]

TOTAL: 70

END OF QUESTION PAPER